

New Haven Pickleball League Code of Conduct

Applies to: All organizers, volunteers, players, participants, spectators, vendors, and community partners

Statement of Commitment

The New Haven Pickleball League (NHVPL) is committed to maintaining a safe, respectful, and supportive environment for everyone in our community. This Code applies equally to players, volunteers, spectators, coaches, organizers, and league leadership, both on and off the court.

No individual, including organizers and leadership, is exempt from this Code or accountability. Silence and inaction enable harm. We choose safety, respect, and accountability every time.

We stand firmly against violence, harassment, intimidation, coercion, and abuse in all forms.

Purpose

This Code ensures that all NHVPL activities, including play, events, digital communication spaces (e.g., TeamReach), and any conduct affecting our community remain safe, respectful, and free from harm.

Zero Tolerance Policy for Violence & Harassment

Anyone convicted or credibly documented as having committed any of the following will be permanently banned from NHVPL participation and events:

- Physical violence or assault
- Sexual harassment, misconduct, or assault
- Domestic or interpersonal violence
- Stalking, coercive control, or intimidation
- Emotional or psychological abuse
- Threats or abusive behavior

NHVPL may take action based on credible evidence even without a criminal conviction in order to protect community safety.

Expected Conduct

All community members must:

- Treat others with dignity and respect
- Practice sportsmanship and fairness
- Avoid language or behavior that demeans, intimidates, or harms
- Support a welcoming and inclusive environment
- Report concerns promptly when safe and appropriate
- Never retaliate against someone who reports a concern or participates in an inquiry

How to Support Teammates & Community Members

We look out for one another. If someone appears uncomfortable, unsafe, or distressed:

- Check in if safe to do so
- Ask if they want support reporting or speaking to a league leader
- Offer to accompany them to report if they choose
- Respect confidentiality and autonomy.
- Listen and validate first

Bystander Responsibility

Everyone plays a role in safety. If you witness harmful behavior:

- Interrupt or speak up if safe to do so
- Notify league organizers promptly
- Support affected individuals without judgment
- Avoid escalating confrontation. Prioritize safety and reporting

Stepping in and speaking up protects our community.

Reporting & Response

If you experience or witness conduct that violates this Code, you are encouraged to report it.

Report to: Chloe Shevlin

Emergency: Dial 911

Anonymous reports are welcome and taken seriously. We make every reasonable effort to protect the privacy of reporters and survivors.

Retaliation against anyone who reports or participates in a review is strictly prohibited.

Reports will be handled respectfully and with care for safety, dignity, and confidentiality where possible.

Duty of Organizers & Leadership

League organizers and leadership must:

- Act on reports and concerns
- Enforce this Code consistently and fairly
- Maintain safe and accessible reporting channels
- Remove individuals who jeopardize community safety
- Model the behavior expected of all participants

Failure by leadership to act when required may itself be a violation.

Consequences

Violations of this Code may result in immediate removal from play, suspension, or a permanent ban from all NHVPL activities and events.

Individuals with confirmed or credibly documented histories of violence or harassment will be permanently banned.

Commitment to Survivors & Community Safety

Our stance is rooted in protecting our community and honoring survivor voices. We will not remain passive in the face of harm. We choose to foster an environment where everyone feels safe, respected, and supported.

Acknowledgment

Participation in the New Haven Pickleball League signifies acceptance of and agreement to abide by this Code of Conduct.